

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Would You Like A Robot Companion?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 30

No.	Sentence
1	Robotics - the _____ robots
2	These machines assist with household chores and _____
3	Not everyone is comfortable with having _____ in their homes
4	Despite this, AI enables robots to form _____ with people
5	Designer: Grace Brown, an engineer from _____
6	During the pandemic, she experienced no _____ for five months
7	Built Abi to offer _____ to those feeling isolated
8	Now manufactures robots for _____ through her company Andromeda
9	Target users: senior citizens in _____ with few visitors
10	Personality traits: _____, inquisitive and curious
11	Visitors are often _____ by her behaviour
12	Appears to possess _____ - acts independently
13	Can perform entertaining actions like blowing _____
14	Height: approximately _____ tall
15	Similar in size to a _____
16	Appearance includes _____ and large eyes
17	Eyes are highly _____, revealing emotions

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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No.	Sentence
18	Design inspired by animated characters from _____
19	Regular conversations with Abi bring _____ and a sense of community to residents
20	Regular conversations with Abi bring joy and _____ to residents

What is Neil's attitude towards having a humanoid robot living with him?

- A He feels he already has enough people around him
- B He welcomes having a robot to help with chores
- C He is excited about the idea of a robot companion
- D He worries about the robot's safety and control

According to the conversation, what is the intended purpose of building Abi, the robot?

- A To entertain children by performing tricks and games
- B To provide elderly people with company and reduce loneliness
- C To carry out household cleaning and maintenance tasks
- D To replace human caregivers in nursing homes completely

In the transcript, what does the word "sassy" imply about Abi's personality?

- A She is shy and reserved when meeting people
- B She acts aggressively and unpredictably
- C She is bold, confident, and slightly cheeky
- D She is highly logical and unemotional

What does it mean when Grace says Abi "has a mind of her own"?

- A Abi always follows human instructions perfectly
- B Abi behaves independently, beyond human control
- C Abi is programmed to obey all commands strictly
- D Abi does not show any personality or curiosity

Why did Grace Brown choose to model Abi to look like a young child?

- A To make Abi appear approachable and endearing
- B To make Abi seem more powerful and intimidating
- C To minimize the robot's size for easier transportation
- D To ensure Abi blends in with adult users better

Which of the following best expresses the effect Abi has on elderly residents?

- A Abi replaces the need for family visits
- B Abi causes confusion and fear among residents
- C Abi brings joy and a feeling of community
- D Abi increases physical activity among the elderly

What contrast does the conversation make between Abi and robots in sci-fi movies?

- A Abi is violent and unpredictable like movie robots
- B Abi is designed for military use rather than companionship
- C Abi is friendly and approachable, unlike typical sci-fi robots
- D Abi is less advanced technologically than fictional robots

What reason does Grace give for Abi having large, expressive eyes?

- A To allow her to see better in dark places
- B To show emotions and make her feel more relatable
- C To give her a scary appearance to protect children
- D To focus more on surveillance and monitoring tasks

What can be inferred about people's reaction when they first meet Abi?

- A They immediately distrust her technology
- B They expect a robot to lack any personality
- C They find her dull and uninteresting at first
- D They are usually surprised by her confident attitude

Why is Abi described as having "a splash of colour" in her design?

- A To hide mechanical parts from people's view
- B To imitate the colour of human skin tones
- C To camouflage her in care home environments
- D To make her visually attractive and less dull